

Leocadia Hartwell

Character Dossier

Melancholy but funny alchemist of Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn

Overview

Leocadia Hartwell is a alchemist living in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn. Leocadia is 25 years old, originally from the Weeping Shoals, and is known around Ring Deck 4 as melancholy but funny. In conversation Leocadia refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Background

Leocadia arrived in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn 22 years ago after leaving the Weeping Shoals under circumstances Leocadia describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Oryn Extraction Consortium; the second was the one that stuck. Today Leocadia works as a alchemist near the hydroponics bay and is paid, when paid at all, in station credits.

Leocadia learned the trade from Eamon Norwood, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Leocadia's life is with Yevgenia Quenneville, over a matter neither will explain. The person Leocadia trusts most is Hamish Norwood.

Current goal: to pay off the last of the debt by winter. Greatest fear: being forgotten.

Personality and speech

Temperament: melancholy but funny.

Speech pattern: Leocadia refuses to say the word 'no' outright.

Tells: when lying, Leocadia mentions Thimble the pigeon for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Leocadia Hartwell
Role	alchemist
Home	Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn
Hometown	the Weeping Shoals
Age	25
Favourite dish	hand-rolled cardamom buns
Pet	Thimble, a pigeon
Lucky number	677

<i>Workshop password</i>	thorn-marble
<i>Mentor</i>	Eamon Norwood
<i>Rival</i>	Yevgenia Quenneville
<i>Closest friend</i>	Hamish Norwood

Secret

Leocadia has never told Eamon Norwood that the famous 'accident' was deliberate.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Leocadia: I am the alchemist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Leocadia: Hand-rolled cardamom buns. Do not tell Yevgenia I said so.

Visitor: Is Thimble yours?

Leocadia: Thimble belongs to nobody. Thimble tolerates me. Lucky number is 677, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 8

Leocadia won 49 station credits on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. Leocadia was hired to carry a sextant from the hydroponics bay to Dockmaster's Row without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Leocadia found a sack of salt half-buried near the hydroponics bay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Leocadia found a wax seal half-buried near the hydroponics bay and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 2, winter of year 8

Leocadia found a hand bell half-buried near Dockmaster's Row and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Leocadia was hired to carry a clockwork bird from Dockmaster's Row to Ring Deck 4 without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. At Dockmaster's Row, Leocadia taught a newcomer how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 3, spring of year 8

Delphine came by asking about the comet. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. At the observation lounge, Leocadia taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 4, spring of year 8

Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the ore refinery. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the ore refinery. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Leocadia closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 5, summer of year 8

Tiberius came by asking about the tax on doors. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Leocadia repaired the clockwork bird at Ring Deck 4 for Mara, who paid in 49 station credits and a long story about the census. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached Ring Deck 4. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 6, summer of year 8

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the comet reached the hydroponics bay. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the harvest count reached the hydroponics bay. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Leocadia closed early, walked to the

observation lounge, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 7, autumn of year 8

Leocadia found a sack of salt half-buried near the observation lounge and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at the observation lounge: 15 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the observation lounge. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Leocadia closed early, walked to Dockmaster's Row, and watched the lights come on. Leocadia closed early, walked to Dockmaster's Row, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 8, summer of year 8

A stranger asked Leocadia for the password to the workshop. Leocadia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the quarantine. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Leocadia and a neighbour outside the observation lounge; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 9, summer of year 9

the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Leocadia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Leocadia was hired to carry a ledger from the observation lounge to Ring Deck 4 without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Leocadia closed early, walked to Ring Deck 4, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the observation lounge. Leocadia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 10, winter of year 9

Leocadia won 21 station credits on a bet about the census and spent all of it on supper. Caspian came by asking about the missing shipment. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Leocadia moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Torvald came by asking about the quarantine. Leocadia said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 11, spring of year 9

Leocadia found a cracked compass half-buried near Ring Deck 4 and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Leocadia and a neighbour outside Ring Deck 4; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Leocadia won 38 station credits on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Leocadia spent the day counting stock at Ring Deck 4: 44 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short.